

MusicMan Load-In Guide

Physical setup & breakdown for a campfire show — cases, cabling, and the order things happen in.

FIELD COPY

This is for getting boxes off the truck, gear on the ground, cables connected, and everything packed back up correctly. It doesn't cover running the show — that's **MusicMan_Manual.html**.

New to this? You don't need to know how any of it works. Every step below is one concrete action — read it, do that one thing, then move to the next. If a step genuinely doesn't make sense standing in front of the gear, stop and ask rather than guess — most of this only works done in order.

Real-world timing: one adult working solo — poles, Music Man Box, and PA (not counting the EZ-Up, screen, projector, or generator) — took about **1 hour 20 minutes**. A second or third person on cables/poles while one runs the console table cuts that down a lot. Not a one-person job if you can help it.

 **Charge Before You Leave** — night before / morning of, not at the site

- ☐ PAR lights ×4
- ☐ Remote
- ☐ iPad mini
- ☐ Solix C300 ×2
- ☐ Projector
- ☐ Generator gas
- ☐ Camera

1 What's in Each Case

Music Man Box

- ☐ MusicMan (Pi unit)
- ☐ Stream Deck
- ☐ Physical remote
M5StickC Plus, MC's handheld control
- ☐ Shure BLX88 wireless mic receiver (2CH)
- ☐ Handheld wireless mics ×2
- ☐ Wired mic stand
- ☐ Wired mic
- ☐ Mic cables (XLR) + receiver power adapter
needs a 110V outlet, at the console
- ☐ AA batteries
for the wireless mics
- ☐ MusicMan plug (110V)
- ☐ iPad mini
- ☐ 3.5mm → dual-XLR (L/R) adapter
MusicMan's audio out, into the PA
- ☐ Pole nodes ×2
yes, these ride here — not in the Lights Box

Add to kit Long Cat6 cable (~100 ft) for the video extender run — not in the photographed inventory. Pack it with this case.

Lights Box

- ☐ PAR lights ×4
2 per pole, battery — no cable
- ☐ Pin spots ×2
1 per pole
- ☐ Stage wash bars ×2
1 per pole
- ☐ Anker Solix C300 ×2
1 per pole
- ☐ 110V extension cords ×2
Solix → pinspot, up the pole
- ☐ Long DMX cables ×2
1 per pole — Wash Bar (bottom) up to the top cluster
- ☐ Short DMX cables ×8
Node→Wash Bar, plus jumpers within the top cluster
- ☐ LED pixel-strip snakes ×2
1 per pole, 5-way splitter
- ☐ 12V node power cables ×2
Solix → Pole Node

Light Stand Case

- ☐ Speaker stands ×2
- ☐ Light stands ×2
- ☐ Extension bars ×2
- ☐ 6" PVC tube, 4 LED modules

Loose / Separate

- ☐ Expedition EZ-Up
big canopy — stage backdrop + backstage/prep area
- ☐ Projector (Nebula Mars 3)
battery-powered, charge before you leave — no cord needed at the screen
- ☐ Spare tripod, for the projector
Mars 3 has a standard ¼-20 mount on the bottom
- ☐ Screen + inflator
- ☐ Video extender kit
HDMI-over-Cat6 balun pair, console ↔ projector
- ☐ Generator
backup only, if no shore power
- ☐ Gas can
- ☐ PA: Fender Venue
stands live in the Light Stand Case
- ☐ General 110V extension cords ×2
one to the console zone, one to the screen/projector zone — separate from the 2 pole cords in the Lights Box. See Power Needed.
- ☐ Power strips ×2
a 4-outlet for the console zone, a small 2-outlet for the screen zone. See Power Needed.
- ☐ Camera
- ☐ Folding table

the console table — Music Man
Box + PA controls sit here

- ☐ **Small step stool**
for reaching the pole fixtures to
aim/adjust them

2 Per-Pole Assembly

Both poles are identical. Finish one completely before starting the second — working on both at once is how cables get crossed.

DMX CHAIN (PER POLE) — BOTTOM OF POLE → TOP OF POLE



Wash Bar sits at the bottom of the pole with the Node. The long cable carries the signal up the pole to the Pinspot/PAR/PAR cluster at the top, where short cables link the three.

1 Raise the pole to full extension

at its marked position. Extend fully before mounting anything — the pixel strip receivers only line up with the strips' magnets at full extension.

2 Set the Solix C300

at the base. Confirm it's charged and powered on before connecting anything to it.

3 Power the Node

run the 12V cable from the Solix's DC output into the Pole Node.

4 Connect the pixel snake

plug the snake into the Node's aircraft connector. Match each of the 5 numbered tails to its numbered strip — number to number. Velcro the bundle near the Node's power port so nothing hangs loose.

5 Wire the DMX chain

Node → Wash Bar → Pinspot → PAR → PAR, per the diagram above.

6 Power the fixtures

see the power map below — wash bar and pinspot both draw off the Solix, PARs are battery-only.

7 Mount & aim

Wash bar — bottom of the pole, on its hook, secured with a wingnut, general stage coverage. **Pinspot + both PARs** — top of the pole, same hook + wingnut mounting; PARs wash the stage generally, the pinspot is a tight aim at dead center, dad/kid standing height. The 5 pixel strips (2 stage-facing, 3 audience-facing) snap on via magnet mounts into their receivers — if one doesn't land, check the pole is fully extended before assuming something's broken.

FIXTURE POWER MAP

Wash Bar (bottom)

Solix AC / inverter output, direct

Pinspot (top)

110V extension cord, Solix AC → up the pole

PAR ×2 (top)

Battery — confirm charged, no cable

3 Site Layout

A In the audience, close to stage

Both poles sit in the audience area, near the stage.

B On the stage/audience line

Both poles sit on the boundary line between stage and audience, spread apart from each other.

Pick whichever fits the site. Either way, fixture aim stays the same: PARs and wash bars wash the stage generally, pinspots hit dead center at dad/kid standing height.

EZ-Up — the big Expedition EZ-Up is the stage backdrop and the backstage/prep area behind it, not a console tent. Raise it early; the console table sets up separately. **Screen** faces the seating area with a clear, reasonably short projector throw — the ~100ft Cat6 run covers the rest of the distance back to the console, so the console doesn't need to be anywhere near the projector. **PA** speakers go on stands, spread apart, facing the crowd. No fixed distances beyond that — read the site and adjust.

4 Power Needed

Everything that needs shore/generator power falls into two physical zones — not one cord per device. The poles are **not** part of this: they run off their own Solix batteries, already accounted for in Section 2.

1 Console Zone

MusicMan Pi unit, BLX88 wireless receiver, and the Fender Venue head/mixer — all three live at the console table. The Venue drives both stage speakers over speaker cable, so only the head unit itself needs power, not each speaker separately. One extension run in, one 4-outlet

2 Screen Zone

Just the screen inflator needs wall power here. The projector (Nebula Mars 3) is battery-powered — it sits at this same location but doesn't need a cord, only the video extender's Rx end and its HDMI cable reaching it. One extension run in, a small 2-outlet strip covers the inflator plus the

power strip splits it three ways (a 4th outlet free for the video extender, if it's powered on this end).

video extender if it's powered on this end instead of the console's.

Video extender only needs power at one end — pick whichever zone has a free outlet on its strip; it doesn't need a run of its own either way.

 **Screen inflator needs continuous power** — not a one-time inflate-and-disconnect. It stays plugged in and running the whole time the screen needs to stay up, or it sags/collapses.

SHORE POWER VS. GENERATOR

A Shore power available

Run one extension cord from the nearest outlet to each zone — 2 cords total. Leave the generator in the truck.

B No shore power — generator

One generator can feed both zones if it's positioned reasonably central between them — still just 2 extension cords, both running back to the generator instead of a wall outlet. Position it downwind/away from seating, confirm gas, start it, and let it settle before loading anything onto it (see Setup Order). If the site won't let one generator position reach both zones, that's a 3rd extension cord run, not a 2nd generator — cord is cheaper and simpler than a second fuel source.

Music Man Box

Needs power at the console, from shore/generator.

Projector (Nebula Mars 3)

Runs on its own built-in battery — no power cord needed at its location, only the video extender's Cat6/HDMI reaching it.

5 PA / Audio Setup — Fender Venue

The Venue is the hub — everything else plugs into it.

→ INTO THE VENUE →

Shure BLX88 (2CH)

↓
2× XLR

Wired Mic

↓
XLR

MusicMan (Pi out)

↓
3.5mm → dual-XLR

Phone

↓
Bluetooth

1 Speakers on stands

disconnect both speakers from the Venue head unit, set on stands spread apart, facing the crowd.

2 Scan for a clear RF group

power the BLX88 at the console (hold its power button). Press and release its group button once — it auto-scans and locks onto the clearest group, setting up both channels on the BLX88 at the same time.

3 Match each handheld to it

turn on mic 1 (batteries installed) and use its own group/channel buttons to set its display to the same group letter the receiver landed on, channel 1. Repeat for mic 2 on channel 2. The receiver's ready LED lights up green next to a channel once that mic is matched correctly.

4 Cable everything in

wired mic, BLX88 receiver (both XLR outs), and MusicMan adapter cable into the Venue per the chart above.

5 Bluetooth

pair a phone if it'll be used.

6 Power last

leave the Venue off until every source above is connected.

 **Mic sounding distorted?** If a receiver channel's audio LED flickers red often (not just on loud moments), hold that mic's channel button for 5 seconds — a dot appears on its display, meaning it's switched to the quieter -10dB setting. Hold the same button 5 seconds again to switch it back to normal.

SETUP

6 Setup Order

1 Site prep

walk the site, confirm the fire circle, mark pole / EZ-Up / screen / PA positions.

2 Raise the EZ-Up

it's the stage backdrop and backstage/prep area, not a console tent. The console table sets up separately, later.

3 Check for shore power

if none, position the generator downwind/away from seating, confirm gas, start it, let it settle before loading anything onto it.

4 Set up the folding table

where the console will go, under/near the EZ-Up. Everything in the Music Man Box and the PA controls end up here.

5 Position the screen

facing the seating area.

6 Inflate the screen

plug in the inflator and confirm it's actually running continuously before moving on — it stays plugged in and blowing the whole show, not a one-time inflate. Don't walk away and unplug it thinking it's done.

7 Position the projector

reasonably short, clear throw to the screen — on the spare tripod (standard 1/4-20 mount on the bottom) or wherever it sits level. Power on by sliding the lens cover down — that's the power switch, there's no separate button. Autofocus and keystone correction trigger automatically on power-on; if the image comes up soft or crooked, nudge the projector slightly or press OK on the remote to re-trigger them.

8 Run the long Cat6 cable

from the projector back to the console.

9 Connect the video/HDMI extender

a pair of small boxes — one end plugs into the projector's HDMI input, the other into the console's HDMI output, with the long Cat6 running between them. Power whichever end is more convenient — only one end needs power. If the projector doesn't switch to the HDMI feed on its own, open the remote's home menu and select it manually.

10 Set up each pole

full per-pole assembly (Section 2), one pole completely before starting the second. Use the step stool to reach the fixtures for aiming — don't aim from the ground by eye.

11 Set up the PA (Fender Venue)

full sequence above: speakers on stands, BLX88 group-scanned and both mics matched to it, everything cabled in. Leave the Venue itself off until every source is connected.

12 Set up the Music Man Box

on the console table: Pi unit, Stream Deck, remote, iPad mini, wired mic + stand, BLX88 (power, group scan, match the 2 handhelds, fresh AA batteries in each), MusicMan cable into the Venue.

13 Power on

shore/generator first, then the Venue, then Solix units, MusicMan unit last.

14 Verify connectivity

Pi status light: amber (booting) → blue (running) → **green** once both poles check in. Not green usually means a loose cable, not a real failure — worth a look before assuming the worst.

15 Walk the Show Flow, live, on the console

step through every entry from the start, confirming each one actually fires the right music/light/video before the audience shows up. The best way to catch a loose cable or wrong setting while it's still easy to fix.

16 Hand off

to the show operator for a final check of lights, sound, and display before the show starts.

BREAKDOWN

7 Breakdown Order

 **Shut the Pi down before touching its power.** Press the power button once and wait for the status light to go **solid white** — that's a few seconds, not instant — before unplugging anything. White means it actually finished shutting down; cutting power earlier risks corrupting the SD card.

1 Pack the Music Man Box

mics off, batteries out if it'll sit a while, everything back in its case slots.

2 Power down each pole

fixtures off, then Node, then Solix. Disconnect in reverse: PAR→PAR, PAR→Pinspot, Pinspot→Wash Bar, Wash Bar→Node.

3 Coil every cable individually

not as one tangled bundle — the fastest way to turn a quick teardown into a slow one next time.

4 Lower and pack each pole

fixtures and pixel strips secured so nothing swings loose in the case.

5 PA, screen, EZ-Up

down in that order.

6 Generator

let it cool before packing; confirm the gas can is sealed.

7 Final sweep

walk the site for anything left behind before loading the truck.